

- `-f, --force`

This command ignores non-existent files, and no prompt is displayed as it also ignores the interactive option.

Creating links

For creating links in Linux, the `ln` command is used. The command can be used in two way, either

- `ln` file link

To create what we call a hard link or

- `ln -s` item link

A symbolic link where the item is file or directory

Hard links

Hard Links are also known as the original UNIX way of creating links. By default, each file in a Linux system has a hard link which gives it its name. It is important to remember that while creating a hard link, we tend to create an additional directory entry for the file.

The limitations of a hard link are:

1. Hard links cannot reference a file that is not on the same storage disk as itself.
2. Hard links may or may not reference a directory.

Symbolic links

Symbolic Links are more modern than hard links and were created to overcome the limitations presented by hard links. Symbolic Links work by creating a text pointer that references to the file or directory we have to link. In some regards, Symbolic links work the same way as Shortcuts in Windows.

The file identified by the symbolic link, and the symbolic link itself is very abstract to each other, let us say you write something in a symbolic link, the target file is written to it. However, if you delete symbolic connections, only the link is deleted, not the file itself. If a file is deleted before the symbolic link, the link will continue to exist but will point in vain. In this case, the link is allegedly broken. For many to use, the `ls` command will show broken links in partition, as red, to reveal their presence. **d**